Portside Logistics -- Safety and Compliance Guide

Applies to all depot staff, loading dock crew, and drivers across all Portside Logistics facilities.

1. Purpose and Scope

This guide covers the minimum safety steps required before a vehicle leaves the yard, the protective equipment required on the dock and in the cab, and how to report an incident. It is reviewed every year alongside the Vehicle Maintenance Manual and the Hazmat Handling Procedures.

2. Pre-Trip Vehicle Inspection Checklist

Every driver completes a pre-trip inspection before the vehicle leaves the depot, and records the result in the maintenance log. A vehicle that fails any item below is held at the depot until a mechanic clears it.

- Tire condition and pressure on all axles, including the spare.
- Headlights, tail lights, brake lights, and turn signals.
- Brake pedal feel and parking brake hold.
- Mirrors, windshield condition, and wiper function.
- Load securement points, straps, and tie-down rails.
- Engine oil, coolant, and washer fluid levels.

3. Personal Protective Equipment

Steel-toe boots and a high-visibility vest are required on the loading dock at all times, no exceptions for depot visitors either. Gloves are required whenever handling strapped pallets or crates, and additional equipment is required for hazardous cargo as described in the Hazmat Handling Procedures.

4. Incident and Accident Reporting

Any accident, near-miss, or injury -- however minor -- must be reported to the depot safety officer within 1 hour of the event. Photograph the scene if it is safe to do so, and do not move a damaged vehicle until the safety officer says it is clear.

- Call the depot safety officer immediately, then dispatch.
- Photograph the scene, the vehicle, and any damaged cargo.
- Complete the incident form before the end of the shift.
- For any injury, complete a medical follow-up within 24 hours regardless of severity.

5. Load Securement Rules

Cargo must be secured so that it cannot shift more than a few centimeters in any direction under normal braking. Total load weight must stay within the rated capacity printed on the vehicle placard; overloaded

vehicles will not be dispatched.

6. Adverse Weather Driving Protocol

During heavy rain or reduced visibility, drivers reduce speed and increase following distance, and dispatch may add buffer time to the route automatically. Hazmat runs are suspended entirely when wind speed exceeds the threshold set in the Hazmat Handling Procedures, and hill routes require chains or equivalent traction aids when the depot issues a weather advisory.